Weeping European Hornbeam

Carpinus betulus 'Pendula'

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Overlook: 1 **TOTAL 1**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 15–50 ft (sources range 15–20 ft to 40–50 ft; often 15–20 ft if grafted low). **Open:** Mature height highly variable depending on graft and culture; no tight three-source agreement. × 15–40 ft (sources range 15–20 ft to 30–40 ft). **Open:** Spread range varies widely.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 4–7/9 (sources vary). European hornbeam performs in southern landscapes with adequate moisture. Weeping form is typically grafted; height depends on graft height. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms 40–60 ft for species, urban street tree use, moist well-drained soils. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/carpinus-betulus/]
Sun: Full sun to part shade.
Water: Medium. Prefers moist, well-drained soil. Tolerates a range once established.
Soil: Well-drained, adaptable (clay, loam, sand). Prefers fertile.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in well-drained soil. Height is largely determined by graft height. Prune in late summer to mid-winter if needed to shape. Water regularly until established. Suitable as specimen. Can be kept smaller by pruning.
Soil prep: Well-drained, adaptable (clay, loam, sand). Prefers fertile.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Weeping selection of European hornbeam. Old cultivar (France, approx. 1850 per some sources). Typically grafted onto species rootstock.
Form / habit: Deciduous. Weeping. Often top-grafted. Dense, cascading branches that can touch the ground. Slow to moderate growth.
Foliage: Yellow to orange.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Smooth gray. Muscle-like fluting characteristic of the species.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally low issues. Resistant to verticillium wilt noted by some sources. Minimal foliar disease. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a data is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Strongly pendulous branches. - Yellow fall color. - Catkins in spring. - Often grown as grafted standard. - Creates a "room" under the canopy when mature.